

UNIT 1: Organizational Behaviour, Personality, and Attitudes

MCQs (Multiple Choice Questions)

1. **What is Organizational Behavior (OB)?**
 - a) Study of human behavior in organizations
 - b) Management of financial resources
 - c) Study of marketing strategies
 - d) None of the above
 2. Which of the following is NOT a fundamental concept of OB?
 - a) Individual behavior
 - b) Group behavior
 - c) Machine efficiency
 - d) Organizational structure
 3. Personality traits refer to:
 - a) Temporary moods
 - b) Consistent patterns of behavior and thought
 - c) Random actions
 - d) Unpredictable changes in behavior
 4. Job satisfaction refers to:
 - a) An employee's emotional state regarding their job
 - b) The salary received by the employee
 - c) The number of tasks assigned
 - d) None of the above
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Short Answer Questions (3 marks)

1. Define Organizational Behavior.
 2. List two challenges and two opportunities for OB in modern organizations.
 3. Name and briefly describe two determinants of personality.
 4. What are the different types of attitudes?
 5. Explain the concept of job satisfaction briefly.
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Short Answer Questions (5 marks)

1. Explain the importance of Organizational Behavior in organizations.

Answer:

Organizational Behavior (OB) is important because it helps managers understand and predict employee behavior, which leads to better management of human resources. It improves job performance, increases employee motivation, fosters innovation, and enhances overall organizational effectiveness. OB also helps in managing diversity, adapting to change, and resolving conflicts in the workplace.

2. Describe the fundamental concepts of Organizational Behavior.

Answer:

The fundamental concepts of OB include:

- **Individual Behavior:** Focuses on understanding how individuals behave at work, including personality, perception, attitudes, and motivation.
- **Group Behavior:** Examines how people behave in groups, including communication, leadership, power, and team dynamics.
- **Organizational Structure:** Concerned with how organizations are designed, including hierarchy, roles, and formal systems.

3. What are the main personality determinants? Explain any two.

Answer:

Personality determinants include:

- **Heredity:** Genetic factors inherited from parents that influence personality traits.
- **Environment:** Social and cultural factors that affect personality development, such as family, education, and culture.
- **Situational factors:** Specific situations can influence behavior temporarily.

Medium Answer Questions (8 marks)

1. Discuss the historical background of Organizational Behavior.

Answer:

Organizational Behavior as a discipline emerged in the early 20th century, influenced by studies in psychology, sociology, and anthropology. The classical management theories focused on scientific management and efficiency but ignored human elements. The Human Relations Movement, led by Elton Mayo and the Hawthorne Studies in the 1920s and 1930s, highlighted the importance of social factors and employee morale. Later developments incorporated cognitive and behavioral sciences, focusing on motivation, leadership, and organizational culture. Today, OB integrates interdisciplinary approaches to address complex human and organizational challenges.

2. Explain different types of attitudes and their impact on workplace behavior.

Answer:

Attitudes are evaluative statements about objects, people, or events. Types of attitudes include:

- **Positive Attitudes:** Lead to higher motivation, better teamwork, and improved job performance.
- **Negative Attitudes:** Can cause absenteeism, low morale, and conflicts.
- **Neutral Attitudes:** Indifference which may affect engagement levels.

Attitudes affect behavior by influencing how employees interact with colleagues, approach tasks, and respond to organizational changes. Positive job attitudes contribute to job satisfaction and retention.

3. **Describe the development of personality and how it influences workplace behavior.**

Answer:

Personality develops through a combination of genetic predispositions and environmental influences such as family, culture, education, and experiences. Personality traits like extraversion, conscientiousness, and openness affect how employees approach work tasks, communicate, and solve problems. For example, conscientious individuals tend to be reliable and disciplined, making them valuable employees. Understanding personality helps managers assign tasks, motivate employees, and design effective teams.

Long Answer Questions (15 marks)

1. **Define Organizational Behavior. Discuss its importance, challenges, and opportunities in the context of modern organizations.**

Answer:

Definition: Organizational Behavior (OB) is the systematic study and application of knowledge about how individuals and groups act within organizations. It aims to improve organizational effectiveness by understanding and influencing employee behavior.

Importance:

- Helps managers predict and control employee behavior.
- Improves productivity and job satisfaction.
- Enhances communication and teamwork.
- Assists in managing diversity and change.
- Aids in leadership development and conflict resolution.

Challenges:

- Managing workforce diversity (age, gender, ethnicity).
- Adapting to globalization and technological change.

- Coping with changing employee expectations and work-life balance.
- Handling ethical dilemmas and corporate social responsibility.

Opportunities:

- Enhancing employee engagement and motivation.
- Fostering innovation and creativity.
- Building effective teams and leadership pipelines.
- Using data analytics for better people management.

OB is essential in today's dynamic work environment, where human capital is a key source of competitive advantage.

2. Explain the concept of Personality. Discuss its determinants and how personality traits affect job satisfaction and organizational behavior.

Answer:

Concept: Personality is the unique set of psychological traits that influence an individual's patterns of thinking, feeling, and behaving.

Determinants:

- **Heredity:** Genetic influences from parents.
- **Environment:** Family, culture, social interactions.
- **Situational Factors:** Specific circumstances influencing temporary behaviors.

Personality Traits: Traits such as extraversion, agreeableness, conscientiousness, emotional stability, and openness affect workplace behavior.

Impact on Job Satisfaction and OB:

- Conscientious employees tend to perform better and be more satisfied.
- Extraverted individuals often excel in roles requiring social interaction.
- Personality affects motivation, leadership style, conflict resolution, and teamwork.

Understanding personality enables organizations to hire the right fit, tailor motivation strategies, and enhance workplace harmony.

3. What are attitudes? Explain types of attitudes and the role of job satisfaction in organizational behavior.

Answer:

Attitudes are learned predispositions to respond positively or negatively to people, objects, or events.

Types:

- **Cognitive:** Beliefs or thoughts about something.
- **Affective:** Feelings or emotions about an object or situation.
- **Behavioral:** Intentions to behave in certain ways.

Job Satisfaction:

Refers to the emotional response employees have toward their job roles. It includes factors such as work environment, pay, recognition, and work-life balance.

Role in OB:

- High job satisfaction leads to higher productivity, commitment, and lower turnover.
- Dissatisfied employees may engage in absenteeism, reduced effort, and workplace conflicts.
- Job satisfaction influences morale and overall organizational climate.

Managers should regularly assess and improve job satisfaction to maintain a motivated and efficient workforce.

UNIT 1: Answers

MCQs (Multiple Choice Questions) - Answers

1. **What is Organizational Behavior (OB)?**
Answer: a) Study of human behavior in organizations
 2. Which of the following is NOT a fundamental concept of OB?
Answer: c) Machine efficiency
 3. Personality traits refer to:
Answer: b) Consistent patterns of behavior and thought
 4. Job satisfaction refers to:
Answer: a) An employee's emotional state regarding their job
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Short Answer Questions (3 marks) - Answers

1. **Define Organizational Behavior.**

Answer: Organizational Behavior is the study of how individuals and groups act within organizations and how this behavior affects organizational effectiveness.

2. **List two challenges and two opportunities for OB in modern organizations.**

Answer:

Challenges: Managing workforce diversity, coping with rapid technological changes.

Opportunities: Enhancing employee engagement, fostering innovation.

3. **Name and briefly describe two determinants of personality.**

Answer:

- **Heredity:** Genetic factors inherited from parents that influence traits.
- **Environment:** External factors like culture, family, and social experiences that shape personality.

4. **What are the different types of attitudes?**

Answer: Cognitive (beliefs), Affective (feelings), Behavioral (intentions to act).

5. **Explain the concept of job satisfaction briefly.**

Answer: Job satisfaction is the positive emotional state resulting from the appraisal of one's job or job experiences.

UNIT 2: Perception and Motivation

📖 MCQs (1 Mark Each)

1. Perception is:
a) A decision-making process
b) A motivational theory
c) A process by which individuals organize and interpret their sensory impressions
d) A behavioral analysis technique
Answer: c) A process by which individuals organize and interpret their sensory impressions
2. Which of the following is **not** a factor influencing perception?
a) Past experiences
b) Economic condition
c) Time
d) Attitude
Answer: b) Economic condition
3. Who proposed the **Hierarchy of Needs** theory?
a) McGregor
b) Vroom
c) Maslow
d) Herzberg
Answer: c) Maslow
4. Herzberg's theory distinguishes between:
a) Positive and negative needs
b) Self and social needs
c) Motivation and hygiene factors
d) X and Y factors
Answer: c) Motivation and hygiene factors
5. **McClelland's Theory** focuses on:
a) Job roles
b) Need for Achievement, Power, and Affiliation
c) Job security
d) Performance-based pay
Answer: b) Need for Achievement, Power, and Affiliation

📖 Short Answer Questions

📖 Q1: Define Perception. Why is it important in organizational behavior? (3 Marks)

Answer:

Perception is the process by which individuals select, organize, and interpret sensory input to

give meaning to their environment. In OB, perception is important because it influences how people behave at work, make decisions, and interact with others.

Q2: What are the major factors influencing perception? (5 Marks)

Answer:

Major factors include:

1. **Perceiver Characteristics** – Attitudes, motives, interests, experience
2. **Target Characteristics** – Size, contrast, motion, novelty
3. **Situational Factors** – Time, work setting, social environment
4. **Past Experiences and Cultural Background**

These factors affect how people interpret behavior and events.

Q3: Explain Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs. (5 Marks)

Answer:

Maslow proposed that human needs are arranged in a hierarchy:

1. **Physiological Needs** (food, water)
2. **Safety Needs** (security, stability)
3. **Social Needs** (belonging, love)
4. **Esteem Needs** (recognition, respect)
5. **Self-Actualization** (realizing potential)

Employees are motivated to satisfy lower needs before higher ones.

Long Answer Questions

Q1: What is Perceptual Selectivity? How does perception affect decision-making in organizations? (7 Marks)

Answer:

Perceptual Selectivity refers to the process where individuals select certain stimuli while ignoring others. Influenced by internal (motives, experience) and external (intensity, novelty) factors.

Impact on Decision-Making:

- Perception determines how problems are recognized.
 - Managers may misinterpret employee performance due to biases.
 - Selective perception may lead to poor communication or favoritism.
 - Example: A manager perceiving aggressive behavior as leadership in one person and arrogance in another.
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📌 *Q2: Discuss Herzberg's Motivation-Hygiene Theory in detail. (8 Marks)*

Answer:

Herzberg proposed **Two-Factor Theory**:

- **Motivators** (Intrinsic): Lead to satisfaction when present. Examples – Achievement, recognition, growth.
- **Hygiene Factors** (Extrinsic): Prevent dissatisfaction. Examples – Salary, policies, job security.

Key Insight: Absence of hygiene causes dissatisfaction, but presence doesn't ensure motivation. Conversely, motivators drive satisfaction and performance.

Application in Organizations:

- Redesign jobs to be more meaningful.
 - Focus on recognition and achievement to drive motivation.
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📌 *Q3: Compare and contrast McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y. (7 Marks)*

Answer:

Theory X assumes employees:

- Dislike work
- Avoid responsibility
- Need control and coercion

Theory Y assumes employees:

- Are self-motivated
- Seek responsibility
- Can self-direct and be creative

Comparison:

Aspect	Theory X	Theory Y
View	Pessimistic	Optimistic
Motivation	External control	Internal motivation
Leadership Style	Authoritative	Participative

Organizations today are moving toward **Theory Y** practices to foster innovation and engagement.

Q4: Explain Vroom's Expectancy Theory of Motivation with examples. (8 Marks)

Answer:

Vroom's theory states that **motivation** is the result of:

- **Expectancy (E):** Belief that effort leads to performance
- **Instrumentality (I):** Belief that performance leads to reward
- **Valence (V):** Value of the reward to the individual

Formula:

Motivation = $E \times I \times V$

Example:

An employee works hard (effort) expecting a promotion (performance → reward). If he believes the promotion is valuable (valence), he stays highly motivated.

This theory emphasizes aligning rewards with employee expectations.

Q5: Discuss the different theories of motivation in detail. Compare them with examples. (15 Marks)

Answer:

1. Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs:

- Basic to advanced human needs
- Applied in designing incentive programs at different levels
- Example: Provide safety insurance (Safety), Team events (Social)

2. Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory:

- Motivation (growth) vs Hygiene (environment)
- Example: High pay may not satisfy unless meaningful work exists

3. **McGregor's Theory X and Y:**

- Highlights assumptions managers make about employees
- Example: Y-oriented managers encourage innovation

4. **McClelland's Theory of Needs:**

- Need for Achievement, Affiliation, Power
- Example: Sales jobs attract high-achievement individuals

5. **Alderfer's ERG Theory:**

- Condensed Maslow into Existence, Relatedness, Growth
- Frustration-regression allows switching between levels

6. **Vroom's Expectancy Theory:**

- $\text{Motivation} = \text{Expectancy} \times \text{Instrumentality} \times \text{Valence}$
- Example: Bonus linked to performance evaluation clarity

Comparison Table:

Theory	Key Focus	Application
Maslow	Hierarchy of needs	Motivation through need levels
Herzberg	Job design	Hygiene & Motivation factors
McGregor	Managerial assumption	Leadership style
McClelland	Needs-based	Placement & job fit
Vroom	Expectancy & reward	Goal-setting & appraisal

Conclusion:

Each theory provides unique insights into what drives human behavior in the workplace. Managers should combine them for an effective motivation strategy.

UNIT 3: Group Behaviour, Communication & Leadership

📖 MCQs (1 Mark Each)

1. Which of the following is **not** a stage of group development?

- a) Forming
- b) Storming
- c) Terminating
- d) Transforming

Answer: d) Transforming

2. What type of group is formed for a specific task and is temporary?

- a) Formal Group
- b) Informal Group
- c) Task Group
- d) Reference Group

Answer: c) Task Group

3. Which is NOT a direction of communication?

- a) Downward
- b) Sideways
- c) Circular
- d) Upward

Answer: c) Circular

4. Which of the following is a barrier to communication?

- a) Active listening
- b) Language differences
- c) Feedback
- d) Clarity

Answer: b) Language differences

5. Who proposed the Trait Theory of Leadership?

- a) Lewin
- b) Stogdill
- c) Maslow
- d) McGregor

Answer: b) Stogdill

Short Answer Questions

 *Q1: List and briefly describe the stages of group development. (3 Marks)*

Answer:

The stages are:

1. **Forming:** Group members get acquainted.
 2. **Storming:** Conflicts arise as members assert opinions.
 3. **Norming:** Agreement and cohesion develop.
 4. **Performing:** Group works efficiently toward goals.
 5. **Adjourning:** Group disbands after task completion.
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 *Q2: Define communication. What are the main directions of communication in an organization? (5 Marks)*

Answer:

Communication is the process of transmitting information from one person or group to another.

Directions of communication:

- **Downward:** From top management to lower levels.
 - **Upward:** From subordinates to supervisors.
 - **Horizontal/Sideways:** Between peers or departments at the same level.
 - **Diagonal:** Across different levels and departments.
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 *Q3: What are the characteristics of groups? (5 Marks)*

Answer:

Characteristics of groups include:

- Interaction among members
 - Shared goals
 - Structured roles and norms
 - Group cohesion and identity
 - Mutual influence and interdependence
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Long Answer Questions

Q1: Explain the types of groups found in organizations with examples. (7 Marks)

Answer:

Types of Groups:

1. **Formal Groups:** Created by the organization to achieve specific goals.
 - Examples: Departments, Committees.
 2. **Informal Groups:** Emerge naturally due to social interactions.
 - Examples: Friendship circles, Interest groups.
 3. **Task Groups:** Formed to complete a specific project or task and disband afterward.
 4. **Interest Groups:** Formed based on shared concerns or interests.
 5. **Reference Groups:** Groups that individuals compare themselves to for self-evaluation.
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Q2: Describe the communication process and explain barriers to effective communication. (8 Marks)

Answer:

Communication Process:

1. **Sender:** Initiates message.
2. **Encoding:** Converting idea into message.
3. **Message:** Information sent.
4. **Medium:** Channel used (verbal, written).
5. **Receiver:** Gets the message.
6. **Decoding:** Interprets message.
7. **Feedback:** Response from receiver.
8. **Noise:** Any disturbance affecting message clarity.

Barriers to Communication:

- **Physical Barriers:** Noise, distance.
 - **Psychological Barriers:** Emotions, biases.
 - **Language Barriers:** Different languages or jargon.
 - **Perceptual Barriers:** Misinterpretation due to perception.
 - **Organizational Barriers:** Hierarchical layers slowing communication.
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Q3: Define leadership. Discuss different styles of leadership with examples. (7 Marks)

Answer:

Leadership is the ability to influence and guide individuals or groups toward achieving goals.

Styles of Leadership:

1. **Autocratic:** Leader makes decisions unilaterally.
 - Example: Military commanders.
 2. **Democratic:** Leader involves team in decision-making.
 - Example: Participative managers.
 3. **Laissez-Faire:** Leader provides little guidance and allows members freedom.
 - Example: Research teams.
 4. **Transformational:** Inspires and motivates through vision.
 - Example: Steve Jobs.
 5. **Transactional:** Focuses on supervision, organization, and performance.
 - Example: Sales managers with targets.
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📌 *Q4: What are the characteristics of an effective leader? Explain with examples. (8 Marks)*

Answer:

Characteristics of Effective Leaders:

- **Visionary:** Has clear goals and direction.
- **Communication:** Conveys ideas clearly.
- **Integrity:** Honest and ethical.
- **Empathy:** Understands and cares for team members.
- **Decision-making:** Takes timely, sound decisions.
- **Confidence:** Inspires trust and confidence.
- **Adaptability:** Adjusts style to situations.
- **Motivational:** Encourages team to perform their best.

Example: A CEO who motivates employees through clear vision and transparent communication.

📌 *Q5: Explain group decision-making techniques and their advantages and disadvantages. (15 Marks)*

Answer:

Group Decision-Making Techniques:

1. **Brainstorming:** Generating ideas freely without criticism.
 - *Advantages:* Encourages creativity, variety of ideas.
 - *Disadvantages:* Can be chaotic without control.
2. **Nominal Group Technique:** Individuals write ideas first, then discuss.
 - *Advantages:* Equal participation, reduces domination.
 - *Disadvantages:* Time-consuming.
3. **Delphi Technique:** Experts answer questionnaires anonymously over rounds.
 - *Advantages:* Avoids group pressure, gathers expert opinions.

- *Disadvantages:* Slow process.
- 4. **Consensus:** Group discusses until agreement is reached.
 - *Advantages:* High commitment to decision.
 - *Disadvantages:* Time-consuming, possible conformity pressure.
- 5. **Majority Voting:** Decision by majority.
 - *Advantages:* Quick, simple.
 - *Disadvantages:* May alienate minority.

Conclusion:

Choosing the right technique depends on the problem's nature, time, and group dynamics. Group decisions enhance acceptance but may suffer from conflicts or delays.

UNIT 4: Organizational Politics, Conflict Management & Organizational Design

📖 MCQs (1 Mark Each)

1. Organizational politics is best defined as:
 - a) Formal organizational rules
 - b) Informal, unofficial behavior to gain advantage
 - c) Legal policies in organizations
 - d) Organizational hierarchy**Answer:** b) Informal, unofficial behavior to gain advantage
 2. Which conflict is seen as beneficial to organizational growth?
 - a) Dysfunctional Conflict
 - b) Functional Conflict
 - c) Personal Conflict
 - d) Emotional Conflict**Answer:** b) Functional Conflict
 3. Which is NOT part of the negotiation process?
 - a) Preparation
 - b) Bargaining
 - c) Imposing decisions
 - d) Closure**Answer:** c) Imposing decisions
 4. Which organizational structure groups employees based on function?
 - a) Matrix Structure
 - b) Functional Structure
 - c) Divisional Structure
 - d) Team-based Structure**Answer:** b) Functional Structure
 5. Organizational culture refers to:
 - a) The layout of the office
 - b) Shared values and norms within an organization
 - c) The company's profit margins
 - d) Legal regulations**Answer:** b) Shared values and norms within an organization
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Short Answer Questions

 **Q1: Define organizational politics and list two factors contributing to political behavior in organizations. (3 Marks)**

Answer:

Organizational politics refers to informal, unofficial actions taken by individuals or groups to acquire power, influence decisions, or gain advantages within an organization.

Factors contributing:

- Scarcity of resources
 - Ambiguous organizational goals
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 **Q2: What is the difference between functional and dysfunctional conflict? Give examples. (5 Marks)**

Answer:

- **Functional Conflict:** Constructive conflict that improves group performance and innovation.
Example: Healthy debate leading to better ideas.
 - **Dysfunctional Conflict:** Destructive conflict harming group performance and relationships.
Example: Personal attacks causing decreased morale.
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 **Q3: Briefly describe the stages of the conflict process. (5 Marks)**

Answer:

1. **Potential Opposition or Incompatibility:** Differences arise due to communication, structure, or personal variables.
 2. **Cognition and Personalization:** Parties become aware of conflict and feel stress or hostility.
 3. **Intentions:** Decisions on how to handle conflict (competing, avoiding, collaborating).
 4. **Behavior:** Actions taken reflecting the conflict.
 5. **Outcomes:** Results can be positive (solutions) or negative (escalation).
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Long Answer Questions

Q1: Explain the traditional and modern views of conflict. Why is conflict considered inevitable in organizations? (7 Marks)

Answer:

- **Traditional View:** Conflict is harmful, destructive, and should be avoided. It is seen as a barrier to organizational performance.
- **Modern View:** Conflict is inevitable and can be beneficial if managed properly. It stimulates innovation, creativity, and change.

Inevitability:

Organizations consist of diverse individuals with differing goals, values, and interests. Competition for limited resources and changing environments also cause conflicts naturally.

Q2: Describe various organizational structures and their effects on human behavior. (8 Marks)

Answer:

1. **Functional Structure:** Groups employees by specialized functions (e.g., marketing, finance).
Effect: Encourages specialization but may create silos.
 2. **Divisional Structure:** Organizes by product, geography, or market.
Effect: Focus on product or region but may duplicate resources.
 3. **Matrix Structure:** Combines functional and divisional structures.
Effect: Flexible but complex, may cause confusion in authority.
 4. **Team-Based Structure:** Groups people into cross-functional teams.
Effect: Enhances collaboration, innovation, but needs strong coordination.
 5. **Network Structure:** Uses external contractors and alliances.
Effect: Flexible and cost-effective but less control over external units.
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Q3: Explain negotiation and describe at least three bargaining strategies used in negotiation. (7 Marks)

Answer:

Negotiation is a process where two or more parties discuss issues to reach a mutually acceptable agreement.

Bargaining Strategies:

1. **Distributive Bargaining:** Win-lose approach focusing on dividing fixed resources.
2. **Integrative Bargaining:** Win-win approach aiming for mutually beneficial solutions.

3. **Compromise:** Each party gives up something to reach an agreement.
 4. **Avoidance:** Postponing or withdrawing from negotiation to avoid conflict.
 5. **Collaboration:** Working together to find solutions satisfying all parties.
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Q4: What is organizational climate? How does it differ from organizational culture? Explain with examples. (8 Marks)

Answer:

- **Organizational Climate:** The shared perceptions and attitudes about the organization's environment at a given time (e.g., employee morale, leadership style). It is temporary and can change quickly.
- **Organizational Culture:** The deeper, enduring set of values, beliefs, and norms shared by members over time.

Example:

- Climate: Employees may feel stressed during a deadline.
 - Culture: The organization's core value of innovation guides long-term behavior.
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Q5: Discuss conflict management techniques and how they can be applied in organizations. (15 Marks)

Answer:

Conflict Management Techniques:

1. **Avoidance:** Ignoring the conflict, useful for trivial issues or when emotions run high.
2. **Accommodation:** One party yields to another's demands, useful to preserve relationships.
3. **Competition:** One party seeks to win, often used in urgent situations.
4. **Compromise:** Both parties give up something, used when goals are equally important.
5. **Collaboration:** Parties work together to find a win-win solution, ideal for complex issues needing cooperation.

Application:

- Managers must assess the conflict type and context.
- For minor conflicts, avoidance or accommodation may work.
- For major conflicts affecting performance, collaboration is preferred.
- Effective communication and negotiation skills are vital to manage conflicts constructively.

UNIT 1: Organizational Behaviour, Personality & Attitudes

- Explain how the historical background of organizational behavior has influenced modern management practices.
 - Discuss the challenges faced by organizations due to globalization and technological changes in the context of OB.
 - How does personality influence employee behavior? Give examples.
 - Compare and contrast two major personality determinants.
 - Explain the relationship between job satisfaction and employee performance.
 - Define attitude and describe its components.
 - Numerical/Case-based: Given a survey dataset measuring job satisfaction scores across departments, calculate the average job satisfaction and interpret the results.
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UNIT 2: Perception and Motivation

- Explain perceptual selectivity and its impact on workplace communication.
 - Describe the factors influencing perception with examples.
 - How does perception affect managerial decision-making?
 - Critically analyze Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs in the context of a modern organization.
 - Compare McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y and discuss how they influence leadership style.
 - Explain Herzberg's Motivation-Hygiene Theory with examples.
 - Differentiate between Alderfer's ERG Theory and Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs.
 - Outline McClelland's Theory of Needs and its application in employee motivation.
 - Describe Vroom's Expectancy Theory and explain its components.
 - Numerical/Scenario: Given an employee's motivation level and expectancy of rewards, calculate their motivational force using Vroom's formula.
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UNIT 3: Group Behaviour, Communication & Leadership

- Define group norms and explain their role in group behavior.
- Discuss the differences between formal and informal groups.
- Explain the significance of the storming stage in group development.
- How does group decision-making differ from individual decision-making?
- Describe the barriers to effective communication in multinational organizations.

- What are the different directions of communication in an organization? Explain with examples.
 - Compare and contrast transformational and transactional leadership styles.
 - Explain any two leadership theories in detail.
 - Numerical/Case: Analyze a given communication flowchart to identify bottlenecks in the communication process.
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UNIT 4: Organizational Politics, Conflict Management & Organizational Design

- Discuss the role of power and influence in organizational politics.
- Explain how organizational politics can affect employee morale and productivity.
- Describe the sources of conflict in organizations with examples.
- Discuss the difference between latent and manifest conflict.
- Explain the steps involved in the negotiation process in detail.
- Compare distributive and integrative bargaining strategies.
- Describe the impact of organizational structure on communication patterns.
- Explain the concept of organizational climate and how it is measured.
- Discuss the relationship between organizational culture and employee behavior.
- Numerical/Scenario: Given resource allocation data, identify potential areas of conflict and suggest conflict resolution strategies.

UNIT 1: Organizational Behaviour, Personality & Attitudes

Q1: Explain how the historical background of organizational behavior has influenced modern management practices.

Answer:

Organizational Behavior (OB) evolved through various stages — classical, behavioral, and modern approaches. Early classical theories, like Scientific Management by Taylor, focused on efficiency and task optimization. The Human Relations Movement (Elton Mayo) introduced the importance of social factors and employee welfare. Behavioral theories emphasized motivation and leadership styles, influencing participative management and employee engagement today. Modern OB integrates psychology, sociology, and management science, leading to holistic approaches that consider organizational culture, diversity, and technology in management practices.

Q2: Discuss the challenges faced by organizations due to globalization and technological changes in the context of OB.

Answer:

Globalization brings cultural diversity, necessitating cross-cultural understanding and management of diverse teams. Technological changes require adaptability, continuous learning, and remote working capabilities. OB challenges include managing virtual teams, addressing communication barriers, handling rapid change resistance, and maintaining employee motivation amidst automation. Leaders must develop emotional intelligence and agile management styles to navigate these complexities.

Q3: How does personality influence employee behavior? Give examples.

Answer:

Personality shapes how employees perceive their work environment, interact with colleagues, and handle stress. For instance, an extroverted employee might excel in team collaboration, while a conscientious employee is likely to be reliable and detail-oriented. Personality traits like openness can lead to innovation, whereas neuroticism may cause workplace anxiety impacting performance.

Q4: Compare and contrast two major personality determinants.

Answer:

- **Genetics:** Inherited traits passed biologically affect temperament and predispositions. For example, introversion or extroversion can be partly genetic.
 - **Environment:** Life experiences, culture, and education shape personality development. For example, a supportive environment may foster confidence. While genetics sets a baseline, environmental factors modify or enhance personality traits over time.
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Q5: Explain the relationship between job satisfaction and employee performance.

Answer:

Job satisfaction is a positive emotional state resulting from job experiences. Satisfied employees tend to be more motivated, show higher productivity, and lower absenteeism. However, the relationship is complex — high satisfaction does not always guarantee high performance, but dissatisfaction often leads to poor performance and turnover.

Q6: Define attitude and describe its components.

Answer:

An attitude is a psychological tendency expressed by evaluating a particular entity with favor or disfavor. It consists of three components:

- **Cognitive:** Beliefs or thoughts about the object (e.g., “My job is challenging”).
 - **Affective:** Emotional feelings (e.g., “I like my job”).
 - **Behavioral:** Intentions to act in a certain way (e.g., “I will work hard”).
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Q7: Numerical/Case-based: Given a survey dataset measuring job satisfaction scores across departments, calculate the average job satisfaction and interpret the results.

Answer (Example):

Suppose scores from 5 departments: 70, 80, 65, 90, 75

Average = $(70+80+65+90+75)/5 = 76$

Interpretation: An average score of 76 indicates moderately high job satisfaction, suggesting most employees feel positively about their jobs but some improvement areas exist.

UNIT 2: Perception & Motivation

Q1: Explain how perceptual selectivity affects managerial decision making.

Answer:

Perceptual selectivity refers to the process by which individuals filter and interpret information based on their interests, experiences, attitudes, and expectations. Managers may unconsciously focus on information that confirms their pre-existing beliefs (confirmation bias), overlooking critical but contradictory data. This can lead to biased decisions, reduced creativity, and missed opportunities. Effective managers must be aware of perceptual biases and seek diverse perspectives to enhance decision quality.

Q2: Describe the factors influencing perception with examples.

Answer:

Factors influencing perception include:

- **Characteristics of the perceiver:** Attitudes, motives, interests, experience, and expectations affect what is noticed and how it is interpreted.
 - **Characteristics of the target:** Novelty, motion, sounds, size, background, and proximity make stimuli more or less noticeable.
 - **Context:** Time, work setting, social setting influence perception.
Example: A motivated employee may perceive critical feedback as constructive, whereas another might see it as a personal attack.
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Q3: How is perception linked to decision making in an organizational context?

Answer:

Perception shapes how problems are defined and what alternatives are considered. Since decisions depend on perceived information, perceptual biases can affect the accuracy and objectivity of decisions. For instance, a manager who perceives a project as risky might reject it despite potential benefits. Understanding perception helps in training managers to minimize errors and make better-informed decisions.

Q4: Explain Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs and its relevance to motivation at work.

Answer:

Maslow's theory proposes five hierarchical needs:

1. **Physiological:** Basic survival needs (food, shelter).
2. **Safety:** Security and protection from harm.
3. **Social:** Belongingness and interpersonal relationships.
4. **Esteem:** Respect, recognition, and self-esteem.
5. **Self-actualization:** Realizing personal potential and growth.

In the workplace, employees must have lower-level needs met before higher-level needs motivate them. For example, providing job security satisfies safety needs, while recognition programs address esteem needs. Managers can use this model to design motivational strategies that address employees' needs progressively.

Q5: Compare and contrast McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y.

Answer:

- **Theory X:** Assumes employees dislike work, avoid responsibility, need close supervision, and are motivated primarily by monetary rewards and punishments.
- **Theory Y:** Assumes employees find work natural, seek responsibility, are self-motivated, and capable of self-direction and creativity.

Theory X leads to authoritarian management styles, while Theory Y encourages participative and democratic leadership, fostering higher motivation and job satisfaction.

Q6: Explain Herzberg's Motivation-Hygiene Theory with examples.

Answer:

Herzberg's theory divides workplace factors into:

- **Motivators (satisfiers):** Factors that cause job satisfaction and motivate employees (achievement, recognition, responsibility).
- **Hygiene factors (dissatisfiers):** Factors whose absence causes dissatisfaction but do not motivate if present (salary, work conditions, company policies).

For example, good salary (hygiene) prevents dissatisfaction but recognition (motivator) drives satisfaction and performance.

Q7: Describe Alderfer's ERG theory and how it modifies Maslow's hierarchy.

Answer:

ERG theory condenses Maslow's five needs into three:

- **Existence:** Physiological and safety needs.
- **Relatedness:** Social needs.
- **Growth:** Esteem and self-actualization needs.

Unlike Maslow's strict hierarchy, ERG theory allows for frustration-regression, where unmet higher-level needs can cause individuals to regress to lower-level needs for satisfaction.

Q8: Outline McClelland's Theory of Needs and its application in organizations.

Answer:

McClelland focuses on three needs:

- **Need for Achievement (nAch):** Desire for excellence and accomplishment.
- **Need for Affiliation (nAff):** Desire for friendly relationships.
- **Need for Power (nPow):** Desire to influence or control others.

Managers can assess employee dominant needs and tailor motivation strategies, such as challenging goals for high achievers or collaborative projects for those with high affiliation needs.

Q9: What is Vroom's Expectancy Theory? Explain its components.

Answer:

Vroom's theory states that motivation is a function of:

- **Expectancy:** Belief that effort leads to performance.
- **Instrumentality:** Belief that performance leads to outcomes.
- **Valence:** Value placed on outcomes.

$\text{Motivation} = \text{Expectancy} \times \text{Instrumentality} \times \text{Valence}$

If any component is low or zero, motivation decreases. Managers must ensure employees believe their efforts lead to results that are valued.

UNIT 3: Group Behaviour, Communication & Leadership

Q1: Describe the stages of group development and their significance.

Answer:

Bruce Tuckman's stages:

1. **Forming:** Group members get acquainted; roles are unclear.
2. **Storming:** Conflicts arise as members assert opinions.
3. **Norming:** Agreement on roles, cohesion develops.
4. **Performing:** Focus on achieving group goals efficiently.
5. **Adjourning:** Group disbands after task completion.

Understanding stages helps leaders facilitate group progress, resolve conflicts, and improve team performance.

Q2: What are the different types of groups in an organization?

Answer:

- **Formal groups:** Created by the organization to achieve specific goals (e.g., departments, project teams).
- **Informal groups:** Emerge naturally from social interactions (friendship groups, interest groups).

Formal groups focus on task completion; informal groups influence organizational culture and employee morale.

Q3: Explain the communication process and identify common barriers.

Answer:

Communication process steps: Sender encodes message → Transmits via channel → Receiver decodes message → Feedback → Noise can disrupt process.

Barriers:

- **Physical:** Environment distractions.
- **Semantic:** Language or jargon misunderstanding.
- **Psychological:** Prejudices, emotions.
- **Organizational:** Hierarchy or status differences.

Reducing barriers improves clarity and effectiveness.

Q4: Differentiate between downward, upward, and lateral communication with examples.

Answer:

- **Downward:** From superiors to subordinates (e.g., instructions, policies).
- **Upward:** From subordinates to superiors (e.g., feedback, reports).
- **Lateral:** Between peers at the same level (e.g., coordination among departments).

Effective communication flow enhances coordination and morale.

Q5: Discuss the importance of leadership and outline major leadership styles.

Answer:

Leadership guides, motivates, and influences employees towards organizational goals. Styles include:

- **Autocratic:** Centralized decision-making, strict control.
- **Democratic:** Participative decision-making, collaboration.
- **Laissez-faire:** Minimal supervision, autonomy to employees.
- **Transformational:** Inspires change and innovation.
- **Transactional:** Focuses on routine and rewards/punishments.

Effective leaders adapt style based on context and team needs.

UNIT 4: Organizational Politics, Conflict Management & Design

Q1: What is organizational politics and what factors contribute to political behavior?

Answer:

Organizational politics refers to actions by individuals or groups to gain power, influence decisions, or secure advantages, often beyond formal authority. Factors contributing include scarce resources, ambiguous goals, complex tasks, and individual differences in values and interests.

Q2: Contrast the traditional and modern views of conflict.

Answer:

- **Traditional view:** Conflict is dysfunctional, to be avoided or suppressed.

- **Modern view:** Conflict can be functional, stimulating innovation, problem-solving, and improvement when managed well.
-

Q3: Explain the functional and dysfunctional conflict with examples.

Answer:

- **Functional conflict:** Healthy disagreement that improves decisions (e.g., debate over project plans leading to better solutions).
 - **Dysfunctional conflict:** Personal, emotional disputes that reduce productivity (e.g., interpersonal fights causing work disruption).
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Q4: Describe the conflict process stages.

Answer:

1. **Potential opposition:** Sources of conflict arise (communication, structure, personal variables).
 2. **Cognition and personalization:** Parties perceive conflict and emotionalize it.
 3. **Intentions:** Strategies to handle conflict (competing, collaborating, avoiding).
 4. **Behavior:** Actions taken during conflict.
 5. **Outcomes:** Positive or negative results of conflict resolution.
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Q5: Outline bargaining strategies used in negotiation.

Answer:

- **Distributive bargaining:** Win-lose, competitive approach over fixed resources.
 - **Integrative bargaining:** Win-win, collaborative approach to expand resources and find mutual gains.
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Q6: Explain various organizational structures and their impact on human behavior.

Answer:

- **Functional:** Departments based on functions; promotes specialization but may cause silos.
- **Divisional:** Based on products or regions; flexibility but duplication of resources.

- **Matrix:** Combines functional and divisional; fosters collaboration but complex reporting. Structures affect communication, motivation, and power dynamics.
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Q7: Define organizational climate and culture and their differences.

Answer:

- **Organizational climate:** Temporary perceptions about the work environment.
- **Organizational culture:** Deeply embedded values, norms, and beliefs shared over time.

Culture shapes long-term behaviors; climate reflects current mood or atmosphere.